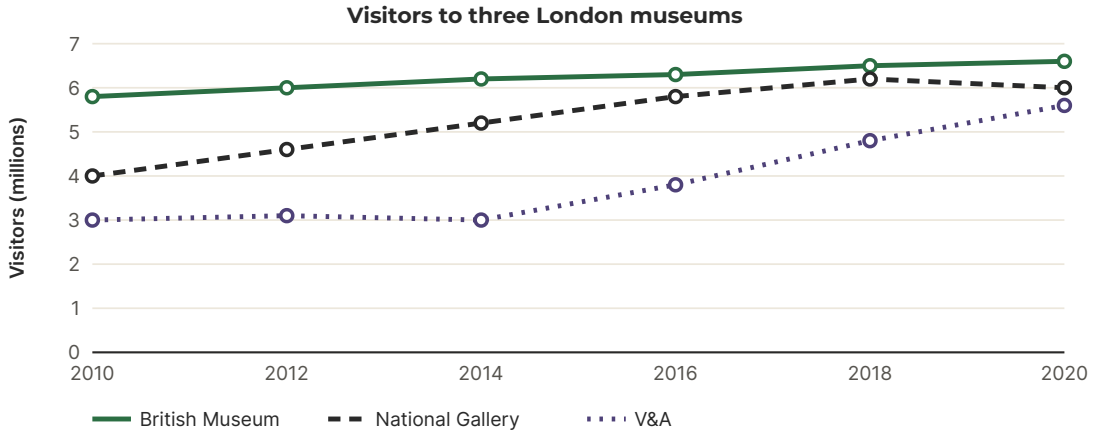
Visitors to three London museums

Paraphrase without changing the meaning. For each numbered gap, write the option that fits both the meaning and the grammar. Some original words are best kept: you don't need to replace every word. The answer key is at the back.

The line graph shows the number of visitors to three major museums in London from 2010 to 2020.



The line graph **(1)** _____ the number of **(2)** _____ to three major **(3)** _____ in London over a ten-year **(4)** _____. Overall, **(5)** _____ rose at all three museums, and the British Museum remained the most popular throughout.

The British Museum attracted 5.8 million **(6)** _____ in 2010, and its **(7)** _____ rose gradually to 6.6 million by 2020. In contrast, the National Gallery **(8)** _____ faster growth. Its visitor numbers climbed steadily from 4 million, **(9)** _____ 6.2 million in 2018 before falling slightly to 6 million in 2020.

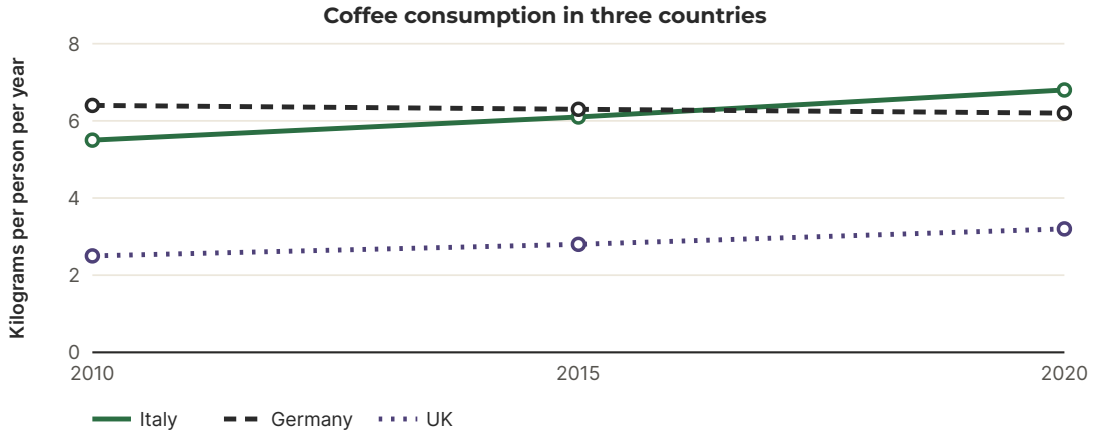
The V&A showed the most uneven pattern. Its attendance remained **(10)** _____ at around 3 million until 2014, then rose sharply, reaching 5.6 million by the end of the **(11)** _____.

GAP	OPTIONS	MY ANSWER
1	illustrates · shows · proves	
2	visitors · museum-goers · tourists	
3	museums · cultural institutions · galleries	
4	period · decade · timeline	
5	attendance · visitor numbers · footfall	
6	visitors · attendees · holidaymakers	
7	visitor numbers · attendance · visitors	
8	saw · experienced · suffered	
9	peaking at · reaching a high of · levelling off at	
10	relatively stable · roughly unchanged · volatile	
11	period · decade · century	

Coffee consumption in three countries

Paraphrase without changing the meaning. For each numbered gap, write the option that fits both the meaning and the grammar. Some original words are best kept: you don't need to replace every word. The answer key is at the back.

The graph shows coffee consumption per person in Italy, Germany and the UK between 2010 and 2020.



The graph compares coffee **(1)** _____ per person in three countries between 2010 and 2020. Overall, **(2)** _____ rose in Italy and the UK, **(3)** _____ it fell slightly in Germany, and Italy overtook Germany during the **(4)** _____.

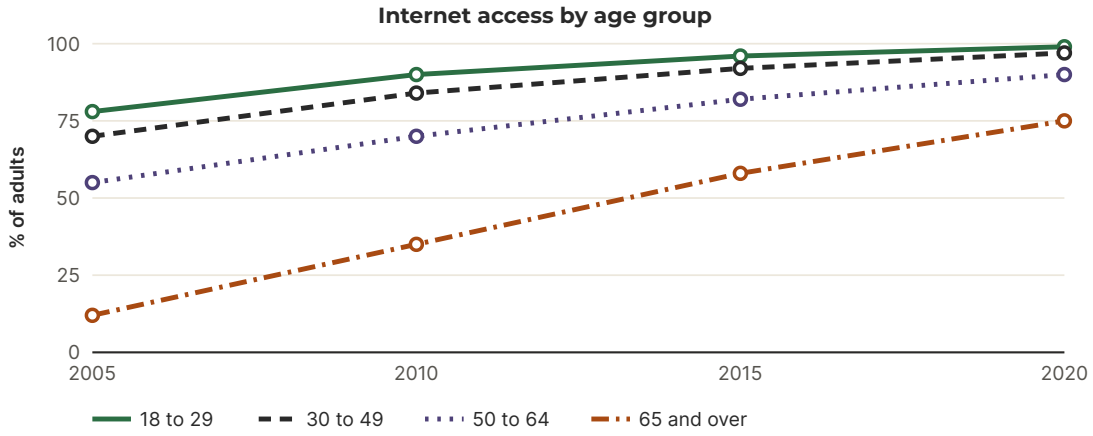
In 2010, the average person in Germany drank 6.4 kg of coffee, more than in Italy (5.5 kg). Over the next ten years, German **(5)** _____ edged down to 6.2 kg, while the Italian figure **(6)** _____ to 6.8 kg, **(7)** _____ Germany between 2015 and 2020. The UK had by far the lowest **(8)** _____ throughout, although consumption there rose by 28%, from 2.5 kg to 3.2 kg.

GAP	OPTIONS	MY ANSWER
1	consumption · intake · demand	
2	coffee consumption · the amount of coffee people drank · coffee production	
3	whereas · while · because	
4	period · decade · timeframe	
5	consumption · intake · drinkers	
6	climbed · rose · soared	
7	overtaking · surpassing · catching up with	
8	figures · consumption · population	

Internet access by age group

Paraphrase without changing the meaning. For each numbered gap, write the option that fits both the meaning and the grammar. Some original words are best kept: you don't need to replace every word. The answer key is at the back.

The line graph shows the percentage of adults with internet access in four age groups in the United States from 2005 to 2020.



The line graph presents the **(1)** _____ of adults with internet access in four **(2)** _____ in the United States from 2005 to 2020. Overall, access **(3)** _____ in every age group, and the gap between the youngest and the oldest group **(4)** _____ considerably.

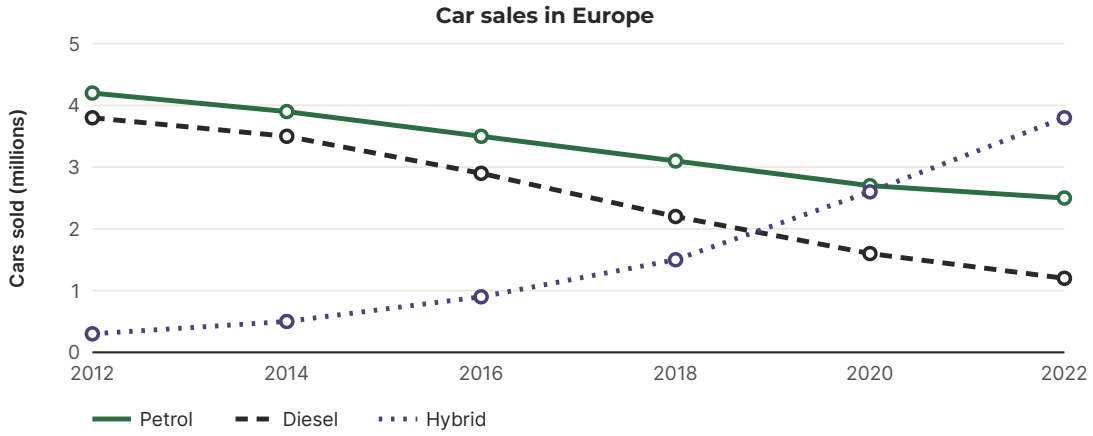
In 2005, 78% of **(5)** _____ aged 18 to 29 were online, compared with only 12% of those aged 65 and over. By 2020, almost all young adults had access (99%), while the figure for the oldest group had risen **(6)** _____ to 75%.

GAP	OPTIONS	MY ANSWER
1	percentage · proportion · number	
2	age groups · age brackets · generations	
3	increased · rose · fluctuated	
4	narrowed · shrank · closed	
5	people · adults · users	
6	more than sixfold · threefold · by 75%	

Car sales in Europe

Paraphrase without changing the meaning. For each numbered gap, write the option that fits both the meaning and the grammar. Some original words are best kept: you don't need to replace every word. The answer key is at the back.

The graph shows sales of petrol, diesel and hybrid cars in Europe between 2012 and 2022.



The graph illustrates **(1)** _____ of three types of car in Europe from 2012 to 2022. Overall, sales of petrol and diesel cars fell, while hybrid sales rose dramatically, and by 2022 hybrids were the best-selling type.

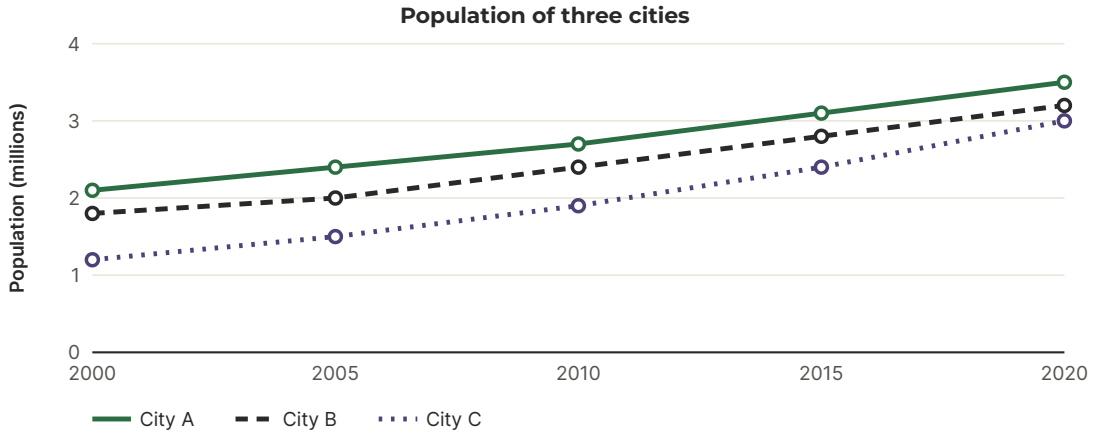
In 2012, petrol cars led the market with 4.2 million **(2)** _____, followed by diesel at 3.8 million, while hybrids accounted for just 0.3 million. By 2018, hybrid sales had **(3)** _____ to 1.5 million. Hybrids **(4)** _____ diesel cars between 2018 and 2020 and petrol cars between 2020 and 2022, reaching 3.8 million. Meanwhile, diesel sales **(5)** _____ to 1.2 million, the lowest figure on the graph.

GAP	OPTIONS	MY ANSWER
1	sales · the number of cars sold · production	
2	cars sold · units · models	
3	increased fivefold · tripled · doubled	
4	overtook · outsold · replaced	
5	fell sharply · declined steadily · levelled off	

Population of three cities

Paraphrase without changing the meaning. For each numbered gap, write the option that fits both the meaning and the grammar. Some original words are best kept: you don't need to replace every word. The answer key is at the back.

The line graph shows the population of three cities from 2000 to 2020.



The line graph compares the **(1)** _____ of three **(2)** _____ over the **(3)** _____ from 2000 to 2020. Overall, the population of all three cities grew, and City C grew the fastest.

In 2000, City A had 2.1 million **(4)** _____, compared with 1.8 million in City B and 1.2 million in City C. City A grew **(5)** _____ to 3.5 million by 2020, while City B reached 3.2 million. City C's population **(6)** _____, rising from 1.2 million to 3.0 million.

GAP	OPTIONS	MY ANSWER
1	population · number of residents · migration	
2	cities · urban areas · regions	
3	twenty-year period · two decades · decade	
4	inhabitants · residents · citizens	
5	steadily · dramatically · erratically	
6	more than doubled · nearly tripled · increased by 3 million	

Exercise 1 · Visitors to three London museums

1. ACCURATE **illustrates**: A good alternative to "shows", so you don't copy the task's verb. POSSIBLE **shows**: Accurate, but it repeats the verb from the task. "Illustrates" or "compares" shows more range. RETHINK **proves**: A graph presents data. It doesn't prove anything.
2. ACCURATE **visitors**: Keep the accurate word. You don't need to replace every word in the task. POSSIBLE **museum-goers**: The meaning is right, but it is informal. Use it once at most. RETHINK **tourists**: Not every museum visitor is a tourist: many are local residents. This changes the meaning.
3. ACCURATE **museums**: Accurate. Repeating "museums" is better than changing the facts. POSSIBLE **cultural institutions**: Accurate but vaguer: it could also mean theatres or libraries. RETHINK **galleries**: The British Museum and the V&A are museums, not galleries. A synonym that changes the facts loses marks.
4. ACCURATE **period**: "Over a ten-year period" is the natural phrase. RETHINK **decade**: "A ten-year decade" repeats itself. "Decade" works in "over a decade", but not after "ten-year". RETHINK **timeline**: A timeline is a diagram of events, not a length of time.
5. ACCURATE **attendance**: Accurate, and a natural word for museums. ACCURATE **visitor numbers**: Accurate and clear. POSSIBLE **footfall**: Footfall is mainly used for shops and town centres. It is understandable, but less precise for museums.
6. ACCURATE **visitors**: Accurate. Repeating the right noun is fine. POSSIBLE **attendees**: "Attendees" usually means people at an event or a meeting, not museum visitors. RETHINK **holidaymakers**: Holidaymakers are people on holiday. The graph counts all visitors.
7. ACCURATE **visitor numbers**: "Its visitor numbers rose" is accurate: the number rose. ACCURATE **attendance**: Accurate: "its attendance rose". RETHINK **visitors**: "Its visitors rose" says the people rose, not their number.
8. ACCURATE **saw**: Neutral and natural: "saw faster growth". ACCURATE **experienced**: Accurate and neutral. RETHINK **suffered**: "Suffered" suggests something bad. Growth in visitors isn't bad news.
9. ACCURATE **peaking at**: Accurate: 6.2 million in 2018 was its highest figure. ACCURATE **reaching a high of**: Accurate and a little more formal. RETHINK **levelling off at**: It didn't stay level: it rose to 6.2 million, then fell.
10. ACCURATE **relatively stable**: 3.0, 3.1, 3.0: almost no change. ACCURATE **roughly unchanged**: Accurate for 3.0 to 3.0 million over four years. RETHINK **volatile**: "Volatile" means unpredictable ups and downs. These figures hardly moved.
11. ACCURATE **period**: Accurate. ACCURATE **decade**: 2010 to 2020 is ten years, so "decade" is accurate here. RETHINK **century**: The graph covers ten years, not a hundred.

Exercise 2 · Coffee consumption in three countries

1. ACCURATE **consumption**: Keep the accurate word. POSSIBLE **intake**: "Intake" is used more for food, nutrients or alcohol. It is understandable, but less natural for coffee. RETHINK **demand**: Demand is how much people want to buy. The graph shows how much they drank.
2. ACCURATE **coffee consumption**: Accurate. ACCURATE **the amount of coffee people drank**: Accurate, and it changes the structure. RETHINK **coffee production**: Production is how much coffee is made, not how much is drunk.
3. ACCURATE **whereas**: Links two contrasting trends in one sentence. ACCURATE **while**: Also links two contrasting trends. RETHINK **because**: "Because" gives a reason. The graph shows a contrast, not a cause.
4. ACCURATE **period**: Accurate and natural. ACCURATE **decade**: 2010 to 2020 is ten years. POSSIBLE **timeframe**: The meaning is right, but "during the timeframe" is less natural than "during the period".
5. ACCURATE **consumption**: Accurate. POSSIBLE **intake**: Understandable, but less natural for coffee. RETHINK **drinkers**: "German drinkers edged down" says the number of people fell, not the amount they drank.
6. ACCURATE **climbed**: A steady rise from 5.5 to 6.8 kg. ACCURATE **rose**: Accurate and neutral. RETHINK **soared**: A rise of about a quarter over ten years is steady. "Soared" suggests a large, rapid rise.
7. ACCURATE **overtaking**: Italy went from below Germany (6.1 against 6.3 in 2015) to above it (6.8 against 6.2). ACCURATE **surpassing**: Accurate and a little more formal. POSSIBLE **catching up with**: True until the lines crossed, but Italy went beyond Germany, so "overtaking" is more precise.
8. ACCURATE **figures**: Accurate. ACCURATE **consumption**: Accurate. RETHINK **population**: The graph doesn't show how many people live in each country.

Exercise 3 · Internet access by age group

1. ACCURATE **percentage**: The graph gives percentages. ACCURATE **proportion**: Accurate: a proportion can be given as a percentage. RETHINK **number**: The graph gives percentages, not how many people.
2. ACCURATE **age groups**: Accurate. ACCURATE **age brackets**: Accurate. POSSIBLE **generations**: Generations are defined by birth year, so the same generation moves into an older group over time. "Age groups" is more precise.
3. ACCURATE **increased**: Every line rose. ACCURATE **rose**: Accurate. RETHINK **fluctuated**: Every line went up at every point. Fluctuating means going up and down.
4. ACCURATE **narrowed**: 66 points in 2005 (78 minus 12), 24 points in 2020 (99 minus 75). ACCURATE **shrank**: Accurate: the gap got smaller. RETHINK **closed**: A gap of 24 percentage points remained in 2020. It narrowed but didn't close.
5. ACCURATE **people**: Accurate. ACCURATE **adults**: Accurate. RETHINK **users**: Only 78% of this group had access, so not all of them were users.
6. ACCURATE **more than sixfold**: 75 ÷ 12 is about 6.3. RETHINK **threefold**: 75 ÷ 12 is about 6.3, so "threefold" understates the change. RETHINK **by 75%**: It rose to 75%, by 63 percentage points. "By 75%" gives the wrong size of change.

Exercise 4 · Car sales in Europe

1. ACCURATE **sales**: Accurate. ACCURATE **the number of cars sold**: Accurate, and it changes the structure. RETHINK **production**: Production is how many cars were made, not how many were sold.
2. ACCURATE **cars sold**: Accurate. ACCURATE **units**: "4.2 million units" is natural for sales figures. RETHINK **models**: A model is a design of car. "4.2 million models" would mean 4.2 million different designs.
3. ACCURATE **increased fivefold**: 1.5 ÷ 0.3 = 5. RETHINK **tripled**: 1.5 ÷ 0.3 = 5, not 3. RETHINK **doubled**: 1.5 ÷ 0.3 = 5, so "doubled" understates the change.
4. ACCURATE **overtook**: Hybrid sales went from below to above: 1.5 against 2.2 million in 2018, 2.6 against 1.6 in 2020. ACCURATE **outsold**: Accurate, as long as you give the period. RETHINK **replaced**: The graph shows sales. It doesn't show that hybrids replaced diesel cars.
5. ACCURATE **fell sharply**: From 3.8 to 1.2 million: a fall of about two thirds. POSSIBLE **declined steadily**: It fell in every period, so "steadily" is true, but it misses how large the fall was. RETHINK **levelled off**: Diesel sales fell in every period. They never levelled off.

Exercise 5 · Population of three cities

1. ACCURATE **population**: Keep the accurate word. ACCURATE **number of residents**: Accurate, and it changes the structure. RETHINK **migration**: Migration is people moving. The graph shows how many people lived in each city, not why the numbers changed.
2. ACCURATE **cities**: Accurate. ACCURATE **urban areas**: Accurate. RETHINK **regions**: A region is usually much larger than a city, so the meaning changes.
3. ACCURATE **twenty-year period**: 2000 to 2020 is twenty years. ACCURATE **two decades**: Accurate: twenty years. RETHINK **decade**: 2000 to 2020 is twenty years, not ten.
4. ACCURATE **inhabitants**: Accurate. ACCURATE **residents**: Accurate. RETHINK **citizens**: Citizenship is a legal status. Not every resident is a citizen.
5. ACCURATE **steadily**: It rose by 0.3 or 0.4 million every five years. RETHINK **dramatically**: A rise of two thirds over twenty years, at an even pace, is steady, not dramatic. RETHINK **erratically**: It rose every five years. Erratic means irregular ups and downs.
6. ACCURATE **more than doubled**: 3.0 ÷ 1.2 = 2.5. RETHINK **nearly tripled**: 3.0 ÷ 1.2 = 2.5. Nearly tripling would mean about 3.6 million. RETHINK **increased by 3 million**: It increased by 1.8 million, to 3 million.